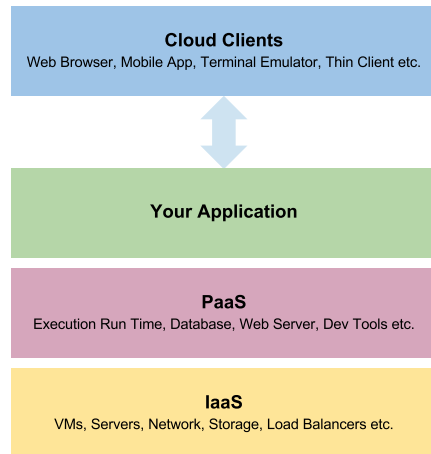


much comfortable are you handling infrastructure, if you're just starting out and working on a standard software stack made available by PaaS providers then PaaS would be the right thing for you. If you want to wield full-control - right from the hardware to the execution environment then IaaS is ideal for you.

Geographical Location

Most of the bigger providers have their data centers spread across the globe. Ideally you would want your servers to be running out of a datacenter that is in a geographically closer to your target customers. For example, it's not feasible for Flipkart to host their servers on Amazon data centers in the US, with their entire customer base here in India. Doing so will unnecessarily increase the round trip time between the client and server and also increase the latency in communication which will lead to sluggish performance of the website affecting the customer experience. This is also crucial if your application has strict QoS requirement, i.e. some tasks need to be performed in real-time, if so then latency in communication due to large distances may be a problem.

A work around here is to use a hybrid of setting up your own physical server or opting for a co-location for your front-facing servers and real time tasks closer to your customers. You can burst to cloud instances in case there is a spike in traffic and your servers are not able to handle the load. At the same time



Cloud Computing Layers

background, monitoring, maintenance and other scheduled tasks which do not have hard real time requirements on the cloud instances.

Bandwidth

Being an emerging economy, India still faces crucial challenges when it comes to last mile bandwidth. It's very difficult to get hold of the exact bandwidth that you can expect on your instance as this will vary from provider to provider. As far as IaaS is concerned, in most cases the bandwidth available is directly proportional to the instance size i.e., larger instance equals to more bandwidth. Hence if your application requires an insanely high speed connection to the internet then you may have to opt for a larger instance size. Usually the internal communication

interfaces between instances have a larger bandwidth.

Transfer Caps

All providers have some transfer caps, usually the inbound traffic is free but they charge per GB on outbound traffic. You're automatically charged per GB based on your usage, there are usage tiers too where the charges on outbound traffic change based on the amount of data actually transferred. Some of the larger providers allow you to directly patch a line into their data centers, this is charged differently and in addition to the internet usage of an instance. This is extremely beneficial for real time systems which need high-bandwidth no-cap connections to their virtualized instances. Some providers which offer free instances have hard caps on data and need you to move to billing if you exceed the cap.

Platform and Languages

By platform we mean the server operating systems made available by the providers. The server ecosystems are dichotomized into Windows and Linux based systems. Most of the software stacks made available by PaaS providers run on Linux except for Windows Azure. You have more if you're using a IaaS solution as you get to select which operating system you want to run on your machine and most providers offer both Windows and Linux instances. Windows instances are



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